

● ELITE PLAN · \$34.99/MONTH

21-DAY PROGRAMME

# MEDITATION AND MINDFULNESS

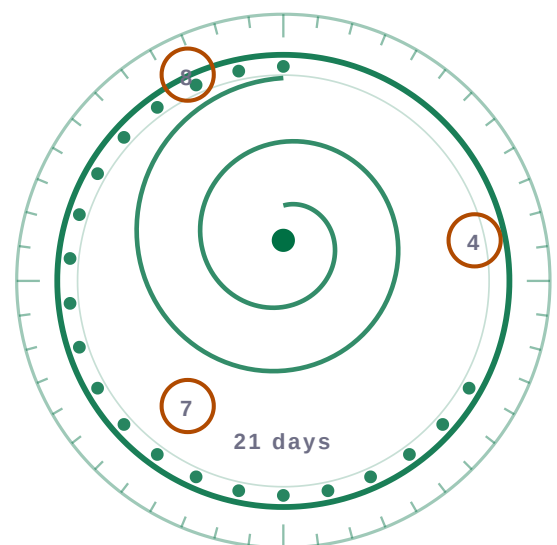
Strong mind, strong body. Three weeks of guided practice designed for people who **train seriously**.

21 DAYS

2 FULL SCRIPTS

3 BREATHING TECHNIQUES

PRACTICE LOG



ATTENTION  
**Paced breathing**

**21**

GUIDED PRACTICES

**5–20**

MINUTES A DAY

**2**

WORD-FOR-WORD  
SCRIPTS

**8**

PAGES

## WHY AN ATHLETE MEDITATES

This is not spirituality, nor «emptying your mind». It is training the ability to **direct your attention** and to drop the nervous system into recovery mode when it is time: two skills that transfer to the heavy set and to deep sleep.

### WHAT YOU CAN EXPECT

- Falling asleep faster on stressful nights
- Better focus on the maximal set
- Less reactivity to a bad day in the gym or on the scale

### WHAT IT IS NOT

- It does not replace psychological or psychiatric treatment
- It is not about emptying the mind: it is about coming back
- It does not work if you only practise when you feel bad

## HOW THE PROGRAMME WORKS

### 01 One practice a day for 21 days

From 5 to 20 minutes, in order. Each day builds on the skill built the day before.

### 02 Same time, same place

A stable context is what turns practice into habit. Mornings, right after getting up, work for most people.

### 03 Losing the thread is the practice

Every time you notice you have drifted and come back, you have done one repetition. That is the training.

### 04 If you miss a day, carry on the next

Do not repeat the missed day and do not start over. Consistency matters more than perfection.

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Technique, duration and description for each day

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Mental rehearsal of your perfect session

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## THE 21 DAYS, ONE BY ONE

| DAY | TECHNIQUE                   | DURATION | WHAT IT INVOLVES                                             | DONE                     |
|-----|-----------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1   | Conscious breathing         | 5 min    | Observe your breath without trying to change it              | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2   | Breath counting             | 7 min    | Count to 10 and start again. If you lose count, go back to 1 | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3   | Body scan                   | 10 min   | Move attention through every part of the body                | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4   | 4-7-8 breathing             | 8 min    | Inhale 4 s, hold 7 s, exhale 8 s                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5   | Walking mindfulness         | 15 min   | Every step with full attention on the foot landing           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 6   | Gratitude meditation        | 10 min   | Three specific things you are grateful for                   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 7   | Athletic visualisation      | 12 min   | Mentally rehearse your perfect session                       | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 8   | Metta (loving-kindness)     | 10 min   | Direct good wishes towards yourself and towards others       | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 9   | Box breathing               | 10 min   | 4-4-4-4: inhale, hold, exhale, hold empty                    | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 10  | Deep body scan              | 15 min   | Full progressive muscle relaxation                           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 11  | Observing thoughts          | 10 min   | Your thoughts are passing clouds; they are not you           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 12  | Mindfulness in the shower   | 5–10 min | Full attention to temperature, sound and touch               | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 13  | Alternate nostril breathing | 10 min   | Nadi Shodhana: one nostril at a time                         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 14  | Walking meditation          | 20 min   | Walk outdoors with complete presence                         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 15  | Goal visualisation          | 15 min   | Your best self six months from now, in detail                | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 16  | Athletic body scan          | 12 min   | Attention to tension before and after training               | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 17  | Advanced 4-7-8 breathing    | 12 min   | Three cycles of ten full breaths                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 18  | Compassion meditation       | 12 min   | Acknowledge your effort and your wins without demanding more | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 19  | Mindful eating              | 20 min   | A whole meal with full attention to flavour                  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 20  | Open awareness              | 15 min   | Observe whatever arises, without judging or steering         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 21  | Free practice               | 20 min   | Choose whichever technique resonated most                    | <input type="checkbox"/> |

### WHAT TO DO ON DAY 22

Keep the **two or three practices** that worked best for you and turn them into routine: one in the morning for focus and one at night for rest. The programme does not end, it simplifies.

## FULL BODY SCAN · 15 MIN

### HOW TO USE IT

Read the text slowly, or record yourself reading it to play back later. Leave a **3-5 second pause** between paragraphs. Position: lying on your back, arms at your sides, eyes closed.

«Close your eyes. Let your body rest completely on the surface beneath you. Feel the weight of your body. You do not need to change anything, only to observe. Breathe naturally...»

«Bring your attention to the soles of your feet. Without judging, without changing, notice any sensation that is there: temperature, tension, contact. Stay here for a few moments...»

«Now move slowly up through the ankles, the calves, the knees. If you find tension, simply name it: tension, warmth, tingling. Then let it dissolve with each exhale...»

«Keep moving up towards the thighs, the hips, the abdomen. With each breath the abdomen rises and falls gently. You are aware of your body's natural rhythm...»

«Bring your attention to the chest and the heart. Feel the soft, steady beat. This heart has been beating your whole life, without a break. Feel gratitude for it...»

«Move up through the shoulders and the arms to the fingertips. Release any tension you have gathered during the day...»

«Finally, bring your attention to the neck, the jaw — unclench your teeth — the eyes and the forehead. Imagine each exhale carrying the day's tension away with it. Your body is heavy and relaxed...»

«When you are ready, gently move your fingers and your toes. Open your eyes slowly. Take a moment before getting up. Carry this calm with you into the rest of the day.»

### A 5-MINUTE VARIANT FOR BEDTIME

Go through only four areas — feet, legs, torso and face — tensing each for 3 seconds and then releasing it completely. The contrast between tension and release is what teaches the body to let go for real.

## ATHLETIC VISUALISATION · 12 MIN

### WHEN TO USE IT

The night before an important session, or 30 minutes before training. Seated, back straight, eyes closed. Mental rehearsal works because it activates **the same neural pathways** as actually performing the movement.

«Sit comfortably, back straight and feet flat on the floor. Take three deep breaths: in through the nose, slowly out through the mouth. With each exhale, let go of the day's noise...»

«Imagine walking into the gym. Feel the temperature of the air, hear the background sound, smell the room. You are here with a clear purpose...»

«You see yourself warming up. The movements are fluid. You notice the body responding, the joint opening, the muscle waking up. Everything is in place...»

«Now you set up in front of the bar. You see the weight. It is demanding, and you are ready. You feel the texture of the grip in your hands, the firm placement of your feet against the floor...»

«You perform the first repetition. Perfect. You feel exactly which muscle is working, the controlled speed on the way down, the precise force on the way up. The technique is flawless...»

«Repetition after repetition, you hold the same quality. When fatigue appears, you recognise it without fear: it is part of the process. You breathe, you reset, you carry on...»

«You finish the last set. You feel the effort well spent, the satisfaction of having done what you set out to do. This is not luck: it is the consequence of your preparation...»

«Take one deep breath. Keep this feeling of control and carry it with you. When you open your eyes, your body already knows what it has to do.»

### THE THREE RULES OF AN EFFECTIVE VISUALISATION

- **First person, not third.** Live it from behind your own eyes; do not watch yourself from outside as if on video.
- **Include every sense.** Touch, sound and muscular effort matter more than the visual image.
- **Rehearse the difficulty too.** Visualising only easy success does not prepare you for the moment the rep stalls.

## THREE BREATHING TECHNIQUES

### TECHNIQUE 1 · 4-7-8 BREATHING (ANTI-STRESS)

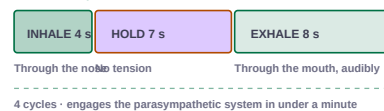
| STEP | ACTION                                                               |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Sit with your back straight or lie on your back                      |
| 2    | Exhale completely through the mouth, audibly                         |
| 3    | Close your mouth and <b>inhale through the nose</b> for a count of 4 |
| 4    | <b>Hold</b> the breath for a count of 7                              |
| 5    | <b>Exhale</b> through the mouth for a count of 8                     |
| 6    | Repeat the cycle 3-4 times. Most effective right before sleep        |

If you feel dizzy, shorten the counts while keeping the 4-7-8 ratio.

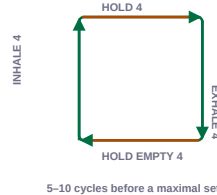
### TECHNIQUE 2 · BOX BREATHING (FOCUS)

FIG. 1 THE PROGRAMME'S TWO BREATHING PATTERNS

4-7-8 TECHNIQUE · BEFORE SLEEP



BOX 4-4-4-4 · FOCUS



Each block's width is proportional to the actual seconds.

### TECHNIQUE 3 · DIAPHRAGMATIC BREATHING (THE BASE)

#### 01 Place your hands

One on the chest and one on the abdomen.

#### 02 Inhale slowly

Only the hand on the abdomen should move.

#### 03 Check the pattern

If the chest hand moves, you are breathing shallowly: the stress pattern.

#### 04 10 breaths every morning

Before getting up. In 3-4 weeks it will be your natural pattern.

#### TAKE CARE WITH BREATH HOLDS

With uncontrolled hypertension, cardiac or respiratory conditions, pregnancy, or anxiety attacks involving hyperventilation, avoid prolonged holds and check with your doctor. Never practise them in water or while driving.



# TAKE IT TO THE GYM AND THE TABLE

| MOMENT                   | 60-SECOND PRACTICE                                    | WHAT IT IMPROVES                                  |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Before the heavy set     | Three box breaths while looking at the bar            | Lowers mental noise and improves activation       |
| Between sets             | Slow nasal breathing, counting the exhale             | Speeds up recovery between efforts                |
| When you finish training | Quick scan: which area stayed tense?                  | Catches compensations before they become injuries |
| Before eating            | Three breaths and one question: am I actually hungry? | Tells physiological hunger from emotional hunger  |
| During the meal          | Put the cutlery down between mouthfuls                | Improves satiety and digestion                    |
| Before sleep             | Four cycles of 4-7-8                                  | Shortens the time it takes you to fall asleep     |

## YOUR 21-DAY LOG

| WEEK   | L                        | M                        | X                        | J                        | V                        | S                        | D                        | HOW I FELT |
|--------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|------------|
| Week 1 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____      |
| Week 2 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____      |
| Week 3 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____      |

## WHAT I LEARNED IN THESE THREE WEEKS

### AN HONEST MEASURE OF PROGRESS

It is not «how long I last without drifting» but **how long it takes me to notice I have drifted**. That time shortens with practice, and it is exactly the skill you then use in real life.

## WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Every number in this document comes from sources that are public, free and checkable. Not one figure is invented, rounded for convenience or copied from another popular publication. This page exists so that you can verify it yourself.

### WHY THESE SOURCES AND NO OTHERS

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| WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR     | WHAT YOU WILL FIND                                                           | WHERE                                                     |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Reference intakes            | RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral       | <a href="https://ods.od.nih.gov">ods.od.nih.gov</a>       |
| Food composition             | The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient                           | <a href="https://fdc.nal.usda.gov">fdc.nal.usda.gov</a>   |
| Dietary guidelines           | Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium       | <a href="https://health.gov">health.gov</a>               |
| Physical activity guidelines | The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement             | <a href="https://health.gov">health.gov</a>               |
| Physical readiness doctrine  | FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness                     | <a href="https://armypubs.army.mil">armypubs.army.mil</a> |
| Lifting equation             | How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation             | <a href="https://cdc.gov/niosh">cdc.gov/niosh</a>         |
| Food safety                  | Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone                               | <a href="https://foodsafety.gov">foodsafety.gov</a>       |
| Health claims                | What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused | European Commission register                              |

### HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

### REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.



# WHEN THE PRACTICE GETS STUCK

| WHAT IS HAPPENING        | WHY IT HAPPENS                                           | WHAT TO DO                                                                 |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| «I cannot stop thinking» | You are trying to empty your mind, which is not the goal | Every time you come back, you have done a repetition. That is the exercise |
| I fall asleep            | You practise lying down and short on sleep               | Practise sitting, with eyes half open, and not in bed                      |
| I get more anxious       | When the outside noise drops, the inside noise appears   | Switch to walking mindfulness or to the shower practice                    |
| I have no time           | You are aiming at sessions that are too long             | Three minutes daily beats twenty minutes once a week                       |
| I get bored              | Expecting «something to happen»                          | Boredom can be observed too. It is usually the way in                      |
| Intense emotions come up | Silence makes room for what you had been covering up     | Open your eyes, breathe and stop. If it recurs, speak to a professional    |

## STRONG MIND, STRONG BODY

The 4-7-8 breathing on page 6 is the piece that **joins the practice to your rest**: use it every night and the programme keeps working while you sleep.

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### IMPORTANT NOTICE

This programme is for informational and educational purposes about relaxation and mindfulness techniques. It does not constitute medical or psychological advice, is not a treatment and does not replace care from a registered health professional. Meditation must not be used as a substitute for therapy or prescribed medication. If you have severe anxiety, depression, post-traumatic stress disorder, or a psychotic or dissociative disorder, consult your mental health professional before starting: some intensive practices can worsen certain conditions. Stop the practice and seek professional help if intense psychological distress appears. Breathing techniques involving breath holds are contraindicated in uncontrolled hypertension, cardiac or respiratory conditions and pregnancy. Copyrighted content: reproduction, distribution or resale without written permission from VILLUMINATIONS is prohibited.